

Swim Meet Nutrient Timing



Intro/Preface

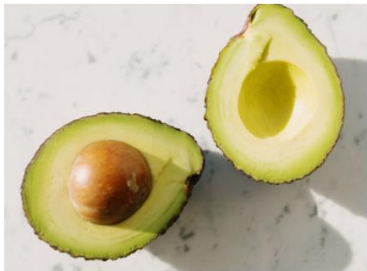
- What you eat in the days BEFORE your meet is crucial
 - Can't "make up" for a bad week of eating
- There's no such thing as a magic menu
 - Each athlete's body processes food differently
- The best way to find out what works for you is trial & error
 - Hard work pays off

Pre-Meet: 3-4 Hours Before (also applies between prelims and finals)

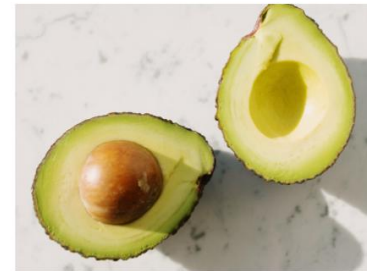
- Carbohydrates should be your main focus (1/2 your plate)
 - Primary fuel source, restore glycogen levels, aid your recovery
- Protein should be your 2nd focus (1/4 plate)
 - Maintain muscle, reduce muscle damage
- Colorful foods should be your 3rd focus (1/4 plate)
 - Help maintain energy levels, reduce inflammation
- Can have a small amount of healthy fat with this meal as well

Food Examples (3-4 Hours Before)

GRILLED CHICKEN W/ AVOCADO, SWEET POTATO, & FRUIT



EGGS W/CHEESE & AVOCADO, TOAST, FRUIT



Pre-Meet: 1.5-2 Hours

- What looks different?
 - Composition (amount of carbs, protein, fat)
 - Portion sizes
- Minimize fat & fiber in this window
- Portion sizes decrease
- Focus on carbs and protein

Food Examples (1.5 - 2 Hours)

Whole Food Options

COTTAGE CHEESE
(2% OR LESS)



PINEAPPLE



+

OR

HARD BOILED
EGG



+

WHITE POTATOES



Blended/Liquid Options

FRUIT & PROTEIN
SMOOTHIE



OR

ORANGE
JUICE



+

COCONUT
WATER



+

1/2 SQUEEZED
LEMON



+

PINCH OF
SALT



Pre-Meet: 1 Hour or Less

- Top off glycogen stores with a quick-digesting carbohydrate
- Avoid fat and fiber
- Keep protein low with this snack
- Food examples:
 - Fruit pouch, banana, dried fruit, electrolyte drink

During a Meet

- Goal: consume 30-60g carbs 30-60 min before races, add small amounts of protein with carbs when you have 1.5+ hours between races
- When possible, opt for whole food options first (processed options work well in the 30-60 min window)
- Eat what your body tolerates well
 - The day of a meet is not a good time to try something new!

Food Examples (During a Meet)

Whole Food Options



Protein/Energy Bars



Watermelon, Honeydew,
Canned Fruit (w/o skin)



Cooked Carrots, Beets,
Squash



Creamy PB & J

Liquid/Supplement Options



Carb Supplement

+



Whey Protein Isolate

OR



Electrolyte Drink

+



EAA Supplement
(for older athletes)

Food Examples (During a Meet)

- Longer breaks between races?
- Refer to 1.5-2 hour examples
- Other examples →
 - Granola
 - Pb & honey
 - Peanut butter pretzels
 - Cheese sticks
 - Jerky

Post-Meet

- As soon as you can, consume carbs + protein (ex: 1% chocolate milk)
- Eat a meal when you get home – if it's late, have at LEAST a snack with carbs/protein
- Composition of this meal will be similar to your meal 3-4 hours pre-meet (or between prelims and finals)
- To aid in recovery, include good sources of:
 - Carbs
 - Color
 - Protein
 - Fat

Food Examples (Post-Meet)

CHICKEN, RICE, VEGGIE BOWL W/ GUAC



SMOOTHIE BOWL W/ FRUIT, GREENS, PROTEIN, NUT BUTTER + GRANOLA/FRUIT TOPPING



+



+



+



=



Application

- Start by setting 1 reasonable goal for yourself in the form of a habit
- It's ok to start broad – your goals will build on each other and get more specific
 - Broad example: I'm going to eat something an hour before my meet
 - Specific example: I'm going to eat ½ banana before my meet
- Once you can do your habit consistently for an extended period of time, make your next goal!

Disclaimer

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